

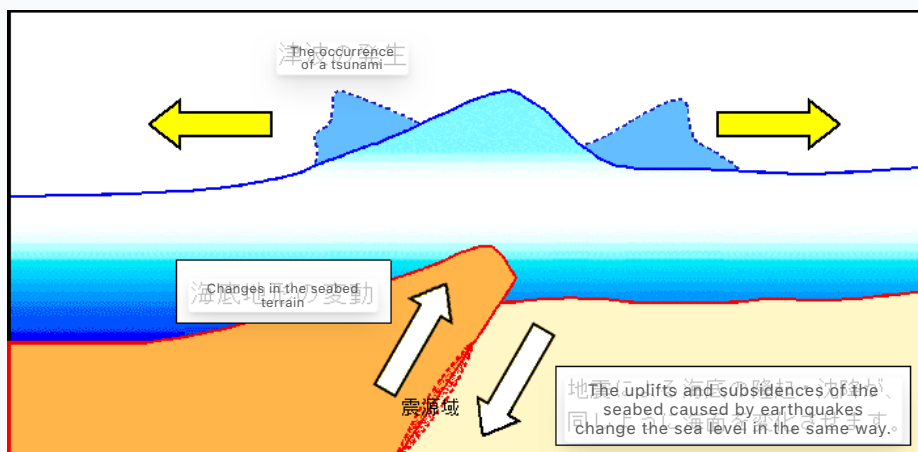
[Japan Meteorological Agency Home](#) >
[Local information](#) > [Aichi Prefecture](#) >
[Explanation of disaster prevention information \(earthquake and tsunami edition\)](#) >
[How tsunamis occur](#)



Explanation of disaster prevention information (earthquake and tsunami edition)

How tsunamis occur

When a large earthquake occurs in a shallow place below the seabed, the ground on the seabed rises or sinks due to the movement of faults. With the deformation of the seabed, the sea level fluctuates, and it spreads in all directions as if it were a stone thrown into a pond. This is the tsunami.



The speed of transmission of tsunamis varies depending on the depth of the sea, and the deeper the sea, the faster it is. Offshore, it is as fast as a jet, and even when it approaches land, it is as fast as a bullet train. You can't escape after seeing a tsunami on the coast. If you feel a strong shaking near the coast, or if you feel a slow shaking for a long time, even if the shaking is small, you must leave the coast immediately.

In addition, the height of the tsunami varies greatly depending on the terrain near the coast. Tsunamis run up the land (called retrograde) and in places with special terrain such as V-shaped valleys, it may be locally higher, so special attention is required.